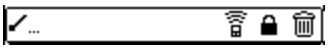
Palm OS Programming Recipes

Customizing the Command Toolbar

Starting in Palm OS® 3.5, entering the Graffiti® command character  displays the command toolbar. Tapping an icon on the command toolbar typically adds a menu event to the event queue, but you can choose to change this behavior in your application.

You do not need to do anything to support the default command toolbar. If your application has an editable field, Field Manager will display icons for cut, copy, and paste on the command toolbar. If your application supports an undo action for a field, Field Manager also displays an icon for undo.

However, you can add custom icons to the command toolbar fairly simply if you want to. To add a custom icon, first choose:

1. The bitmap that will appear on the bar. This bitmap should be 13 pixels high by 16 pixels wide. (Use the system-provided bitmaps when possible. These bitmaps are listed in the Palm OS Programmer's API Reference chapter "Menus.")
2. The action that will occur when the icon is tapped.

Next, add the following code to your form's event handler to handle the event `menuCmdBarOpenEvent`:

```
case menuCmdBarOpenEvent:
    MenuCmdBarAddButton(
            menuCmdBarOnLeft,         //or menuCmdBarOnRight, as desired
            BarSecureBitmap,          //or any other bitmap resource ID
            menuCmdBarResultMenuItem, //this causes the icon to generate
                                      //a menu event...
            ListOptionsSecurityCmd,   //...and this specifies which menu
                                      //event to generate text, if any,
            NULL);                    //to display when icon is tapped

        // include this line to prevent the automatic inclusion
        // of Cut, Copy, and Paste
        event->data.menuCmdBarOpen.preventFieldButtons = true;

        // Don't set handled to true; this event must
        // fall through to the system.
        break;
```

Instead of specifying `menuCmdBarResultMenuItem` (to generate a menu event), you could specify one of the following other actions:

- `menuCmdBarResultNone` - Generate no menu events.
- `menuCmdBarResultChar` - Generate a `keyDownEvent`.
- `menuCmdBarResultNotify` - Generate a notification using `SysNotifyBroadcastDeferred`.